The Moon Book

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 8

Several closed books showed pale circles against dark skies. Nib chose the largest circle, delighted with its moonlike roundness. Lark held the borrower's request beside the actual title. Moon was a word as well as a picture, and only one of these covers carried that title.

“A very moon-shaped moon,” Nib insisted. “A word that says Moon,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **this**

“Oo in moon and pool writes the long /oo/ sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Join m, oo, n. The short words to and do have this sound with a single o; those special spellings need their own explicit model. We won't guess them from the ordinary short o.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try moon, pool, to, do. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Moon on the closed covers,” Lark invited gently. “Which title matches the request?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The moon is up. I can get to the pool.**

“Where can the speaker go?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence gives a destination?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the other books to their compartments. Moon came to the chosen Reed Creek landing. When he put it on a temporary round support, its lower edge began to slide. He caught it gently. The right book had arrived, but lending it still needed a stable reading rest and a completed record.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write moon beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the correct title. Lark kept Moon supported in her wings while Nib inspected the round rest. The next solution would need a broad foot rather than another beautiful circle.